

JapanTravel — Operations Guide

Project: Vicky's Japan trip planner **Stack:** Next.js 15 · Firebase Auth + Firestore · GCP Cloud Run (via Firebase App Hosting) **Repo:** `github.com/benarivicky/JapanTravel` · branch `gcpV3` **Firebase project:** `japantravelplanners-d2992`

Part 1 — Deploy to GCP (Free Tier)

Cost reality

Firebase App Hosting runs on Cloud Run. The **Blaze (pay-as-you-go)** plan is required, but Cloud Run's free tier covers a personal travel app at zero cost:

Resource	Free quota	This app's typical usage
Cloud Run requests	2 M / month	< 5,000 / month
Cloud Run compute	360,000 GB-s / month	< 1,000 GB-s / month
Firestore reads	50,000 / day	< 500 / day
Firestore writes	20,000 / day	< 50 / day
Bandwidth	1 GB / month	< 100 MB / month

Expected monthly bill: \$0. A credit card must be on file to activate Blaze, but no charges occur within these quotas.

Fastest deployment path — Firebase Console (no CLI required)

Prerequisites

- Google account with access to project `japantravelplanners-d2992`
- GitHub account `benarivicky` with repo `JapanTravel`
- The secret values below (already in your `.env.local`)

Steps

1. Open [Firebase Console](#) → [App Hosting](#)
2. Click **Get started** → **Add backend**
3. Connect GitHub → select repo `benarivicky/JapanTravel` → set live branch to `master`
4. Under **Environment variables / Secrets**, add each of these:

Name	Value
NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE_API_KEY	AIzaSyCT81UBSC9sz3F8awSN14xyLWGs_Vre0rc
NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE_AUTH_DOMAIN	japantravelplanners-d2992.firebaseio.com
NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID	japantravelplanners-d2992
NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE_STORAGE_BUCKET	japantravelplanners-d2992.firebaseiostorage.app
NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE_MESSAGING_SENDER_ID	74401408081
NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE_APP_ID	1:74401408081:web:b800d86167f5962ac3c470
GOOGLE_AI_API_KEY	AIzaSyC-9xdKvXH29GN4k9fMnh_jlu4CDUIRtCc

5. Click **Deploy** — Firebase builds and publishes the app automatically.
6. Every subsequent `git push` to `master` triggers a new deploy automatically. No further action needed.

Live URL after first deploy: shown in the Firebase Console under App Hosting → your backend → **Domains**.

Manual deploy from terminal (alternative)

```
npm install -g firebase-tools # once only
firebase login
firebase use japantravelplanners-d2992
npm run build
firebase deploy --only apphosting
```

Requires `.env.local` to be present locally.

GitHub Actions auto-deploy (CI/CD — already configured)

The file `.github/workflows/deploy.yml` runs typecheck → lint → tests → build → deploy on every push to `master` or `gcpV3`.

One-time secret setup in GitHub: Go to `github.com/benarivicky/JapanTravel` → **Settings** → **Secrets and variables** → **Actions** → add the same 7 env vars from the table above, plus:

Secret	Value
<code>FIREBASE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT</code>	JSON content of a GCP service account key with <code>roles/firebaseapphosting.admin</code>

See `DEPLOY.md` → Track A for the `gcloud` commands to create the service account.

Part 2 — Edit the App with AI (Firebase Studio)

Firebase Studio is a browser-based VS Code connected to Gemini. No local install. Opens the GitHub repo directly.

Open the project

1. Go to studio.firebase.google.com 2. Sign in with the Google account that has access to `japantravelplanners-d2992` 3. Click **Import repo** → paste: `https://github.com/benarivicky/JapanTravel` 4. Select branch `gcpV3` 5. Click **Open in Studio** — the IDE opens in the browser (takes ~60 seconds to provision)

Make AI-assisted edits

- Click the **Gemini** icon in the left sidebar (sparkle / stars icon)
- Type your request in plain English or Hebrew, for example:
 - "Change the app title from 'טיול ליפן' to 'הטיול של ויקי'" - "Make the day card headers use a green gradient instead of navy" - "Add a phone number field to the user profile page"
- Gemini proposes a code diff — review it, then click **Accept**
- Use the built-in **Preview** button (▶) to see the change in a live browser window

Save and publish

`Ctrl+Shift+G` → Git panel

1. Stage changed files → write a commit message → **Commit** 2. Click **Sync** (push icon) → pushes to GitHub 3. GitHub Actions automatically builds and deploys to Firebase App Hosting (if set up above) — **or** — In the Studio terminal: `firebase deploy --only apphosting`

Project context for AI (what Gemini knows about this project)

If Gemini gives generic suggestions, paste this context at the start of your prompt:

```
Project: Next.js 15 App Router, Hebrew RTL (dir="rtl"), Tailwind CSS,
shadcn/ui components, Firebase Auth + Firestore (project: japantravelplanners-d2992),
Fredoka font, warm cream + deep navy color scheme.
Main pages: /trip (day cards grid), /trip/[date]/[segment] (detail).
Target users: seniors 65+, large touch targets, high contrast.
```

Quick reference

Task	How
Run locally	<code>npm run dev</code> → localhost:3000
Run tests	<code>npm test</code>
Type check	<code>npm run typecheck</code>
Deploy manually	<code>firebase deploy --only apphosting</code>
View live app	Firebase Console → App Hosting → Domains
View database	Firebase Console → Firestore
View auth users	Firebase Console → Authentication
Edit with AI	studio.firebase.google.com